

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, February 22, 2023, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Spencer Batchelder
At-Large Councilor Matthew Mooshian
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Yoshi Manale, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

None.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Stone to accept the minutes of the February 1, 2023, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

**O’Hearne – yes
Batchelder - yes
Stone - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Limoges - yes
Mooshian - yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 8-0**

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Limoges to accept the minutes of the February 8, 2023, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

O'Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

MAYOR'S NOTES

Mayor Girard reported the New Hampshire Department of Business was going to have a meeting at the Community Center, this was postponed until March 9, 2023 at Noon.

Sullivan County is hosting a website launch tomorrow evening at the Common Man in Claremont at 6 PM.

Arrowhead is hosting a cardboard sled race this Saturday at 2 PM.

Next Tuesday the Claremont School Board is hosting a forum for candidates at the Sugar River Valley Regional Tech Center, at 6 PM.

Fiske Free Library will be closed until March 3rd for carpet installation. There will be limited curbside check out.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Manager Manale, stated over the weekend there was an incident of vandalism at Moody Park. A heavy stone picnic table was destroyed. City Parks and Recreation discourages acts of violence, and the City is in process of installing surveillance cameras at each major park location to help deter future acts of vandalism. If anyone has any information on the events that took place at Moody Park, they are encouraged to call the Claremont Police Department at 603-542-9538.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Mayor Girard reminded all speakers they have five minutes on non-agenda items.

Mike Tetu, Ward 1, shared concerns for Arrowhead and the proposal that has been submitted for the main floor of the lodge.

Norm Blouin, Ward 3, stated disagreement with those who think people are not moving to Claremont because of the lack of housing. Mr. Blouin noted most people he knows that live in this area travel outside of Claremont to work, and if company's want employees to move here they should be responsible for building the housing.

NEW BUSINESS

Ordinance 606 Employee Classification Plan Attachment B

Samantha Lauzon, Human Resources Manager, explained Ordinance 606. Manager Lauzon noted the PAB gave its blessing for the changes to Attachment B, and stated the Ordinance change consists of the removal of the position Human Resources Coordinator, now known as the Human Resources Manager, and adding a Human Resources Director Position. The primary reason for this change is because the scope has expanded, Manager Manale added that the IT department would now report to Human Resources Director. As this position will be vacant in the coming weeks Ms. Lauzon noted it was Important for the next person in this position to hit the ground running with little direction from the City Manager.

The second change is the creation of Finance/Human Resource Specialist. Due to the software conversion, the Finance Clerk's work-load has lessened, and the Human Resources Department needs more assistance, this creation will build a stronger Human Resources Department.

CITY OF CLAREMONT - IN THE YEAR TWO THOUSAND AND TWENTY-THREE

ORDINANCE #606

Amending the City of Claremont's Merit System – Creation of Human Resources Director and Finance/Human Resources Specialist Positions; Amending the Non-Union Employee Classification Plan

THE CITY OF CLAREMONT ORDAINS:

Pursuant to Article III, Sections 24, 25 and Article IV, Sections 51 and 52, of the Claremont City Charter; the City's Merit System as well as the Non-Union Employee Classification Plan (Attachment B) are hereby amended and readopted as follows:

Section 1. Creation and Replacement of Position in the City's Human Resources Department

The City Council hereby establishes, by and through this Ordinance, the position of Human Resources Director which shall be included in the City of Claremont's Merit System and as

part of the list of positions within the City's Human Resources Department. This new position shall replace and eliminate the existing position of Human Resources Coordinator.

Section 2. Compensation of the Human Resources Director

The rate of compensation to be paid to the Human Resources Director shall be established within the parameters of Grade 12 of the Non-Union Employee Pay Schedule at the annualized pay scales as set forth in Attachment C (on file in the City Manager's Office).

Section 3. Creation of Position in the City's Finance Department

The City Council hereby establishes, by and through this Ordinance, the position of Finance/Human Resources Specialist which shall be included in the City of Claremont's Merit System and as part of the list of positions within the City's Finance Department. This is an entirely new position for the City and will not replace or eliminate any other current position within that Department.

Section 4. Compensation of the Finance/Human Resources Specialist

The rate of compensation to be paid to the Finance/Human Resources Specialist shall be established within the parameters of Grade 7 of the Non-Union Employee Pay Schedule at the annualized pay scales as set forth in Attachment C (on file in the City Manager's Office).

Section 5. Non-Union Employee Classification Plan

The compensation of every non-union employee of the City shall be determined by the classification of the job in which such person is employed and in accordance with Attachments B and C to the City's Merit System (which are on file in the City Manager's Office). Upon adoption of this Ordinance, the new version of the Non-Union Employee Classification Plan (Attachment B), which is an exhibit to this Ordinance, shall be implemented with the proposed changes contained therein and consistent with this legislative act.

Section 6. Prior Enactments Superseded

The Non-Union Employee Classification Plan as adopted by action of the City Council concerning those set forth in Attachment B, prior to adoption of this Ordinance, and all prior amendments thereto, are hereby repealed as they pertain to same.

Section 7. Validity

If any article, section, subsection, sentence, clause or phrase of this Ordinance is for any reason held to be unconstitutional or invalid, such decision shall not affect the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Section 8. Effective Date

This Ordinance shall take effect and be enforced immediately upon passage, but shall be retroactive to the first day of the month in which it is passed upon third reading.

A motion was made by Councilor Batchelder and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to pass Ordinance 606 to a second reading.

Councilor Batchelder read Ordinance into the record.

Councilor Stone shared concern and asked if City Administration could create a director's position without creating a new municipal department. City Manager Manale will follow up with legal.

Roll call:

O'Hearne – no

Batchelder - yes

Stone - no

Matteau -yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 6-2

Council Rule Change – 45. Readings

Mayor Girard stated this change is to add reading the explanation of proposed ordinance into the record instead of reading the entire Ordinance into the record.

45. - Readings.

Ordinances shall not be passed until they shall have been read twice. At the first reading the explanation of proposed ordinance or the ordinance in its entirety may be read. At the second reading, the entirety of the ordinance will be read, prior to the public hearing, which is to be held on a separate day at regular meeting of the Council, unless otherwise required. The second reading to be only after advertisement of the ordinance and public hearing.

No ordinance shall be revived or reenacted by mere reference to the title thereof, but the same shall be set forth at length as if it were an original ordinance. No ordinance shall be amended by providing that designated words thereof shall be stricken out and others inserted in lieu thereof, but the ordinance or section as amended shall be set forth in full.

**Changes to Rule
45. - Readings.**

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**New Rule:
45. - Readings.**

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A motion was made by Council Limoges and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to accept rule change: Readings.

Roll call:
O'Hearne – no
Batchelder - yes
Stone - yes
Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes
Limoges -yes
Mooshian - yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 7-1

COMMITTEE REPORTS

None.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Koloski noted the shelter building on Sullivan St, has a broken fence and debris that are obstructing the sidewalk.

Councilor Koloski also noted in the square, there are two lamp posts out, one is in front of the Police Department and the other is right across from it. Manager Manale, noted there has been an audit done, there is an electrical problem, but it is being worked on.

Councilor Koloski also inquired about the Boston Post Cane Awards. City Administration and the Mayor will work together to follow up on this.

Councilor Limoges asked for an update on the bounce house, Manager Manale stated he will get an update from Nancy.

Councilor Stone asked to post the school board election notice on our website.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 7:25 p.m., a motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to adjourn.

Voice vote:
O'Hearne – yes
Batchelder - yes
Stone - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Limoges - yes
Mooshian - yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 8-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council